EXAMPLE 3.12

Two materials X and Y are magnetised, whose intensity of magnetisation are 500 A m^{-1} and 2000 A m^{-1}, respectively. If the magnetising field is 1000 A m^{-1}, then which one among these materials can be easily magnetized?.

Solution

The susceptibility of material X is

$$\chi_{m,\mathrm{X}} = \frac{|\vec{M}|}{|\vec{H}|} = \frac{500}{1000} = 0.5$$

The susceptibility of material Y is

$$\chi_{m,\mathrm{Y}} = \frac{|\vec{M}|}{|\vec{H}|} = \frac{2000}{1000} = 2$$

Since, susceptibility of material Y is greater than that of material X, material Y can be easily magnetized than X.

3.5 CLASSIFICATION OF MAGNETIC MATERIALS

The magnetic materials are generally classified into three types based on the behaviour of materials in a magnetising field. They are diamagnetic, paramagnetic and ferromagnetic materials which are dealt with in this section.

(a) Diamagnetic materials

The orbital motion of electrons around the nucleus produces a magnetic field perpendicular to the plane of the orbit. Thus each electron orbit has finite orbital magnetic dipole moment. Since the orbital planes are oriented in random manner, the vector sum of magnetic moments is zero and there is no resultant magnetic moment for each atom.

In the presence of an external magnetic field, some electrons are speeded up and some are slowed down. The electrons whose moments were anti-parallel are speeded up according to Lenz's law and this produces an induced magnetic moment in a direction opposite to the field. The induced moment disappears as soon as the external field is removed.

When placed in a non-uniform magnetic field, the interaction between induced magnetic moment and the external field creates a force which tends to move the material from stronger part to weaker part of the external field. It means that diamagnetic material is repelled by the field.

This action is called diamagnetic action and such materials are known as diamagnetic materials. Examples: Bismuth, Copper and Water etc.

The properties of diamagnetic materials are

i) Magnetic susceptibility is negative.

ii) Relative permeability is slightly less than unity.

iii) The magnetic field lines are repelled or expelled by diamagnetic materials when placed in a magnetic field.

iv) Susceptibility is nearly temperature independent.

Note

Superconductors are perfect diamagnetic materials. The expulsion of magnetic flux from a superconductor during its transition to the superconducting state is known as Meissner effect. (see figure 3.25)

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